Is there a crisis with reading?

Five facts about reading in decline. Discuss the facts and choose the one you think is most interesting. Say why.

FACT 1

In the USA in 2003, 28% of adults reported reading for pleasure on a typical day. By 2023, this had fallen to 16%.

FACT 2

In the UK, only 32.7% of 8-18 year-olds report that they enjoy reading in their free time.

FACT 3

In England, only 44% of adults said they had read a book in the past year.

FACT 4

Teenage boys are among the least engaged readers, with fewer than 1 in 10 boys aged 14–16 reporting daily reading for pleasure.

FACT 5

Studies across multiple countries indicate that young people are reading less frequently for enjoyment, with digital media often cited as a competing influence.